

Morning Briefing – Tuesday 30 June 2026

Generated: ~05:45 BST | London | Data collected: 05:00–05:45 BST | End of Q2 2026

2. Important News

1. Comcast announces tax-free spinoff of NBCUniversal and Sky into separate public company

Source: Reuters / Barron's | Pre-market: Comcast +25%

Why it matters: Largest media structural break-up in years; forces sector re-rating for Comcast (CMCSA), Sky, and media peers. Comcast ex-dividend \$0.33 dated July 1.

2. Alphabet joins Dow Jones Industrial Average for first time; closes +~5% on debut

Source: Yahoo Finance / TheStreet | Monday June 29

Why it matters: Dow hits above 52,000 for first time. Index rebalancing flows completed; Alphabet now part of benchmark tracker buying universe.

3. US and Iran agree to halt strikes; peace talks resume Tuesday in Middle East

Source: CNBC / Schwab Market Update | Weekend ceasefire

Why it matters: Brent crude recovers from 4-month low (~\$72/bbl). Removes immediate tail risk; oil supply premium compresses. Talks could break down intraday.

4. SpaceX (SPCX) confirmed for Nasdaq 100 index addition on July 7

Source: Nasdaq / Reuters | Shares +2.3% premarket to \$156.70

Why it matters: Passive tracker forced-buy event. SpaceX went public June 12 (largest-ever IPO). Index inclusion accelerates momentum, but valuation above \$2 trillion remains contested.

5. Nvidia drops 4.2% Monday; worst week in over a year last week (-~9%) on AI capex doubts

Source: CBS News / Yahoo Finance | Nasdaq tech selloff

Why it matters: AI semiconductor bellwether under pressure as investors question ROI on trillion-dollar data centre build. Watch for second leg lower or stabilisation today.

3. European Futures (Pre-Open ~05:30 BST)

Index	Futures Level	Expected Move	Note
Euro Stoxx 50	6,326	+flat/slight bid	Opened at 6,329; US rally supportive
DAX	n/a	+0.3–0.6% est.	Inferred from US +1.2%; Iran de-escalation
CAC 40	n/a	+0.3–0.5% est.	Inferred; Q2-end window dressing risk
FTSE 100	n/a	+0.1–0.3% est.	Oil recovery positive for energy heavyweights
S&P 500 futures	n/a	Slight positive	Following Monday's +1.18% close
Nasdaq 100 futures	n/a	Mixed	Comcast/SpaceX positive; Nvidia drag

Data time: ~05:30 BST. DAX/CAC/FTSE futures levels not retrieved; moves estimated from context.

4. Yesterday's Closes (Monday 29 June 2026)

Index	Close	Change %	Note
Euro Stoxx 50	n/a	n/a	Fri 26 Jun close: 6,212 (-0.9%)
DAX	n/a	n/a	Fri 26 Jun: -1.3%
CAC 40	n/a	n/a	Fri 26 Jun: -0.6%
FTSE 100	10,502	-0.06%	Minimal move Monday; oil recovery muted

Note: European Monday closes only partially available. Friday 26 June reference levels provided where Monday data absent.

5. US Markets – Monday 29 June 2026 Session

Index	Close	Change	Change %
S&P 500	7,440.43	+86.8	+1.18%
Dow Jones	52,182.74	+306.6	+0.59%
Nasdaq Composite	25,820.14	+524.2	+2.07%

Session tone: Risk-on. Alphabet (+~5%) drove the Nasdaq and lifted sentiment across mega-cap tech. Dow crossed 52,000 for the first time on Alphabet's debut as a Dow member. Middle East de-escalation (US-Iran halt to strikes) removed near-term geopolitical risk premium. S&P 500 remains within 3% of all-time highs. Nvidia (-4.2%) was the notable laggard amid persistent AI capex concern; semiconductors diverged from broader tech.

Leading sectors: Technology, Communication Services (Alphabet), Consumer Discretionary.

Lagging: Semiconductors (Nvidia drag); Energy (oil off highs before Monday recovery).

Key takeaway: The Dow and Nasdaq diverged intraday – index-rebalancing mechanics (Alphabet forced-buy) inflated headline numbers. Underlying tech breadth remains narrower than indices imply.

6. Asian Markets – Overnight Session (29–30 June)

Index	Level	Change %	Note
Nikkei 225	69,077	-0.41%	Tech weakness offset by Iran de-escalation
Hang Seng	22,672	-1.80%	AI/semiconductor selloff; tech led decline
Shanghai Composite	n/a	n/a	In medium-term rising trend channel (technical)
Kospi	n/a	n/a	Not retrieved

Overnight tone: Mixed to negative. Hong Kong bore the brunt of the AI/semiconductor selloff spilling over from Wall Street, with Hang Seng losing 1.8% (-405pts to 22,672). Financial and producer-manufacturing shares added to tech declines. Japan outperformed on a relative basis (-0.41%) as the Iran ceasefire narrative supported export-oriented names and oil-price sensitive sectors recovered. Shanghai technically constructive but data not retrieved. The divergence between Nikkei and Hang Seng reflects local factor sensitivity: Nikkei benefits from weaker yen and energy-price relief; Hang Seng disproportionately weighted to tech/AI.

7. Commodities

Commodity	Price	Change	Note
Brent Crude	\$72.0 / bbl	Recovery	Rebounding from 4-month low; Iran talks positive
WTI Crude	\$69.7 / bbl	+recovery	Below \$70 key level; further upside if talks hold
Gold	\$4,040 / oz	-monthly low	4th straight monthly loss; -10%+ in June. Holds above \$4,000.
Natural Gas (Henry Hub)	\$3.17 / MMBtu	-0.19%	Gradual drift lower; summer demand not providing support
Copper	~\$6.00 / lb	Near 7-week low	Demand concerns weigh; trades below key \$6/lb region

Context: Oil is the most volatile input. Iran ceasefire is fragile – any breakdown in Tuesday talks risks a rapid reversal back toward \$65. Gold's monthly decline reflects reduced safe-haven demand as rate expectations turn more hawkish following Fed and ECB moves. Copper weakness signals softening industrial demand outlook globally.

8. Rates & FX

Instrument	Level	Change / Note
US 10Y Treasury yield	4.39%	Little changed vs prior close
German 10Y Bund yield	2.85%	Near lowest since early March
US-Germany 10Y spread	~154 bp	Wide spread reflects Fed vs ECB divergence
EUR / USD	1.1430	Eased from highs; ECB hike but Fed hawkish
GBP / USD	~1.3400	BoE held 3.75% on June 18 (7-2 vote); next BoE Jul 30
DXY (Dollar Index)	~101.2	Eased from 14-month high of 101.8 (Jun 24)

Context: Fed held 3.50–3.75% on June 17 (Kevin Warsh's first meeting; projections turned hawkish). ECB hiked to 2.25% on June 11 (first hike since 2023) – eurozone CPI at 3.2%. German Bund near YTD lows signals market pricing less further ECB tightening than the June hike implied. Bund move to watch today on German CPI flash release. GBP resilient on BoE hold; two MPC members favoured a hike.

9. DCM – Primary Bond Market

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (29 JUNE 2026)

No specific deal data retrieved for June 29 issuances. European primary market is approaching end-of-quarter, when syndicate desks typically reduce pipeline to allow books to settle. H1 2026 saw record IG gross supply (~\$721bn in Q1 alone, +12% y/y). Late-June activity generally lighter. Full deal log requires Bloomberg/IFR/GlobalCapital access.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY

End-of-quarter issuance window typically quiet. Borrowers that need to print before June 30 balance-sheet date may attempt quick executions today. AI-related corporate supply (hyperscalers, data centre infrastructure) has been an active theme in H1 2026. SSA supply (EIB, EU, KfW) largely ahead of targets. Watch for any opportunistic financial (bank senior preferred / AT1) given tightening credit backdrop and Iran de-escalation narrative.

Specific mandates not available at time of generation.

KEY SPREADS

Index	Level	Change	Direction
iTraxx Main (5Y)	<i>n/a</i>	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not retrieved</i>
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	<i>n/a</i>	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not retrieved</i>
CDX IG (US)	<i>n/a</i>	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not retrieved</i>
Avg EUR Corp IG spread	<i>n/a</i>	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not retrieved</i>

iTraxx / CDX real-time data requires Bloomberg or ICE access. Not available via open-web search.

COMMENTARY

Primary market tone in June 2026 has been choppy: Iranian escalation and renewed inflation concerns created volatility in rates during May-June, making pricing execution uncertain. The US-Iran ceasefire over the weekend partially reopens the window for risk assets and credit. Quarter-end (today, June 30) typically sees reduced primary activity as fund managers avoid marking new inventory. The better tone expected for Tuesday given US equity rally and geopolitical de-escalation may prompt several issuers to hold mandates for July 1 opening. Energy and infrastructure names are best positioned to print given oil price recovery; financials (AT1, bank senior) may be opportunistic. AI/data-centre corporate supply remains the dominant thematic for H2 2026 pipeline.

10. Economic Calendar – Tuesday 30 June 2026

BST Time	Indicator	Consensus	Importance
07:00	Germany Retail Sales (May, MoM)	<i>n/a</i>	Medium
08:00	Germany CPI (June flash, YoY)	~+2.4% est.	HIGH
10:00	Eurozone CPI / HICP (June flash)	~+3.0% est.	HIGH
10:00	Eurozone Unemployment Rate (May)	<i>n/a</i>	Medium
13:30	US Personal Income / PCE (May)	<i>n/a</i>	HIGH
15:00	US Consumer Confidence (June, CB)	<i>n/a</i>	Medium
All week	US Jobs Report (June) – Thursday Jul 2 (early due to July 4 holiday)	<i>n/a</i>	HIGH
All week	US ADP Employment – Wednesday Jul 1	<i>n/a</i>	HIGH
Friday	US markets CLOSED – Jul 3 (Independence Day)	–	–

German CPI and Eurozone HICP flash are today's primary market movers. German May CPI was +2.6% YoY; a lower print today would support Bund rally and ECB pause expectations.

11. Corporate Events & Earnings

Company	Event	Region	Impact
Comcast (CMCSA)	NBCUniversal / Sky spinoff announcement details; ex-div \$0.33 July 1	US	HIGH
Alphabet (GOOGL)	2nd trading day as Dow component; index rebalancing flow continuation	US	HIGH
SpaceX (SPCX)	Nasdaq 100 inclusion confirmed for July 7; continued pre-inclusion trading	US	Medium
Nvidia (NVDA)	No specific event; analyst / broker notes expected following 2-week selloff	US	Medium
ASML	Raised 2026 revenue outlook on AI chipmaking demand; watch follow-through	Europe	Medium
Aixtron	Raised revenue outlook for 2026; surged 12% to 2-year high recently	Europe	Medium

Full earnings calendar (11 reports scheduled): specific European company list not retrieved. Q2 2026 earnings season begins in earnest mid-July.

12. Stocks to Watch

Name / Ticker	Reason	Direction
CMCSA (Comcast)	NBCUniversal / Sky spinoff confirmed; structural upside re-rating. +25% premarket Monday.	BULLISH
GOOGL (Alphabet)	Dow inclusion day 2; sustained index-buying flows, strong fundamental momentum.	BULLISH
SPCX (SpaceX)	Nasdaq 100 addition July 7 confirmed. Pre-inclusion buying; valuation debate ongoing.	BULLISH short-term
NVDA (Nvidia)	Second day of AI capex overhang; worst week in >1yr last week. Broker notes likely today.	BEARISH near-term
BP / SHEL (Energy)	Oil recovering from \$65-area lows on Iran ceasefire. Brent above \$72. Relief trade.	BULLISH (Iran-conditional)
ASML (Amsterdam)	Raised FY2026 revenue outlook; AI chip tool demand strong. European tech anchor.	BULLISH
HWM (Howmet Aerospace)	Morgan Stanley overweight; PT \$315 vs \$275 close. Defense/aerospace demand cycle intact.	BULLISH
LHX (L3Harris Tech)	Morgan Stanley overweight; PT \$390 vs \$293. Defense electronics; NATO spending tailwind.	BULLISH
AIIX (Aixtron)	Raised 2026 revenue outlook; stock near 2-year high. European semiconductor equipment play.	BULLISH

13. Macro / Corporate / Political Highlights

MACRO

1. **Federal Reserve (US):** Held federal funds rate at 3.50–3.75% on June 17 – Kevin Warsh's inaugural meeting as Chair. FOMC projections turned hawkish; median dot now sees rates ending 2026 above current level. Next meeting: late July.
2. **ECB:** Raised deposit rate to 2.25% on June 11 – first hike since 2023. Reaction: Eurozone CPI at 3.2% YoY (May), energy costs +10.8% YoY. June flash CPI released today – key for ECB July decision.
3. **Bank of England:** Held Bank Rate at 3.75% on June 18 in a 7-2 vote; two MPC members preferred a hike. Next BoE meeting July 30.
4. **US Jobs (Thursday July 2):** June payrolls report released early due to July 4. Consensus not yet firm; this is the single most important macro print for Fed rate expectations before summer recess.

CORPORATE

1. **Comcast spinoff:** Plans to split NBCUniversal and Sky into a standalone public company. Largest media restructuring in years; forces sector analyst re-rating across legacy media and streaming.
2. **SpaceX IPO aftermath:** Nasdaq 100 inclusion July 7 comes just three weeks after the June 12 IPO (largest-ever). Valuation above \$2 trillion is contested; near-term supported by inclusion mechanics.
3. **AI capex cycle:** Hyperscalers and data-centre builders expected to issue several hundred billion in new debt in 2026 for infrastructure. Nvidia selloff raises investor concern about ROI realisation timelines.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

1. **US-Iran:** Agreed to halt military strikes over the weekend. Peace talks resume Tuesday. Oil fell to 4-month lows on prior ceasefire expectations; any breakdown risks a rapid re-spike. Strait of Hormuz flow risk remains embedded.
2. **US Market Holiday:** US equity and bond markets closed Friday July 3 (Independence Day observed). Short week compresses liquidity; Thursday jobs report will be the last major US catalyst before the long weekend.

3. **NATO defense spending:** Ongoing European defense budget expansion supports aerospace and defense sector; relevant to HWM, LHX, Rheinmetall, Leonardo, Thales in European context.

14. Key Themes – Top 5 by Horizon

TODAY'S TOP 5

- 1. German / Eurozone CPI flash (June):** Critical print for Bund yields, EUR/USD, and ECB July expectations. May reading was Germany +2.6% YoY; lower today supports rates rally.
- 2. Iran-US peace talks restart:** Oil opens above \$72; any breakdown in Tuesday talks will spike energy markets intraday. Binary risk for energy equities and FX of oil-exporting economies.
- 3. Q2 end rebalancing (June 30):** Quarter-end is today. Portfolio rebalancing, performance window-dressing, and benchmark hedging may distort intraday moves, especially in European and US equity cash.
- 4. Comcast spinoff mechanics:** Analyst upgrades, target price revisions, and sector contagion (Warner, Disney, Sky-linked names) expected throughout the session.
- 5. Nvidia stabilisation or second leg lower:** Whether NVDA finds support or extends its -9% weekly move is a read-through for the entire AI semiconductor complex and Nasdaq sentiment.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

- 1. US June Jobs Report (Thursday July 2):** Payrolls, unemployment rate, wages. Defines Fed July meeting pricing. Released a day early due to July 4 holiday.
- 2. ADP Employment Report (Wednesday July 1):** Advance read on labour market; directional guide for Thursday payrolls.
- 3. ISM Manufacturing PMI (Wednesday July 1):** US economic activity indicator; tariff and supply-chain disruption signals embedded in new-orders subindex.
- 4. SpaceX / Alphabet index mechanics:** SPCX confirmed for Nasdaq 100 July 7; Alphabet Dow inclusion flows settling. Index fund rebalancing volumes elevated.
- 5. Liquidity compression into July 4 weekend:** US markets close Friday July 3. Thin liquidity Thursday afternoon after payrolls print; expect amplified moves.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5 (JULY 2026)

- 1. Q2 2026 earnings season kick-off (mid-July):** First major test of whether AI capex stories convert to revenue. S&P 500 ~3% off all-time highs; bar is high.
- 2. ECB July meeting:** Follow-up to June hike. June CPI flash today is the key input. Another hike or pause will reprice EUR rates significantly.
- 3. Federal Reserve July meeting:** Kevin Warsh's second meeting; hawkish June projections set the table. Market pricing any rate change will move Treasury yields and USD.
- 4. US-Iran nuclear / geopolitical resolution:** Peace talks started Tuesday. A deal removes the energy risk premium entirely; failure risks oil back to \$65+ and inflationary impulse.
- 5. AI infrastructure ROI debate:** Nvidia, AMD, TSMC and hyperscalers (Microsoft, Amazon, Google) reporting in July will define whether the H1 2026 AI capex cycle continues or rolls over.

15. Key Trends to Watch

1 DAY

German CPI print direction: Above 2.4% pushes Bund yields higher and weighs on European equities; below 2.2% fuels Bund rally and opens ECB July pause narrative.

Iran talk headlines (Tuesday session): Binary: ceasefire holds = oil stays above \$70, equities hold gains; breakdown = energy spike, risk-off rotation.

Quarter-end flows: Equity and bond rebalancing expected to drive intraday volatility through European afternoon. Watch for US futures to diverge from cash in European hours.

Nvidia and semiconductor stabilisation: Broker notes and price-target revisions could provide a floor. Absence of support = Nasdaq underperforms again vs Dow.

1 WEEK

US payrolls (Thursday July 2): Consensus around 180k; surprise in either direction will reset Fed pricing and drive DXY, Treasuries, and risk assets for weeks.

ECB communication post-CPI: Any ECB speaker commentary on July meeting stance following today's CPI will move EUR/USD and European bond spreads.

SpaceX Nasdaq 100 pre-positioning: Passive funds must hold SPCX by July 7. Expect elevated volumes and upward drift unless valuation pushback intensifies.

Liquidity and vol into July 4: Short week means compressed trading windows. Amplified moves and potential for gap risk going into the long US weekend.

1 MONTH

Q2 earnings season: July earnings from US tech majors, European banks, and industrials. Key question: does AI capex spending translate to top-line growth?

ECB rate path: Eurozone CPI at 3.2% means ECB cannot easily pause. But growth is fragile. July decision will define the EUR yield curve shape for Q3.

Fed Warsh era: First two FOMC meetings both hawkish. Bond market adjusting to a structurally higher terminal rate view. Watch 10Y Treasury through 4.5% for breakout signal.

Geopolitical risk premium: Iran talks are the wildcard. A deal could cut \$10–15/bbl from oil and drive a significant disinflationary impulse, potentially reopening central bank easing paths in H2.

Sources:

- Reuters – Comcast spinoff, oil / Iran ceasefire, US markets
- Yahoo Finance / TheStreet – US equity closes June 29, Alphabet Dow debut, Asian market data
- CNBC – US market news, Nvidia selloff, tech sector, Asian markets
- Schwab Market Update – Pre-market color, US equity snapshot
- Barron's / Alto – Comcast, SpaceX, Alphabet mentions
- CBS News – Nvidia / AI tech selloff
- Trading Economics – German Bund yield, Natural Gas prices, DXY
- LiteFinance / Econoday – Economic calendar June 30, July week
- Investtech – Nikkei / Asian market morning report June 29
- Amundi Research, Breckinridge, Fidelity – DCM / bond market context 2026
- AhaSignals / MacroMicro – US-Germany yield spread
- Finbold / CBS – SpaceX IPO context, Nasdaq 100 addition
- S&P Global / Morgan Stanley (via search) – Howmet, L3Harris ratings
- Eurostat – Eurozone HICP flash June release schedule

Data collected automatically approx. 05:00–05:45 BST on 30 June 2026. Verify all figures before making any trading or investment decision. Several data points marked n/a where reliable sourcing was unavailable.